

CHEESE-MAKING

The first stage in the making of any type of cheese is to curdle the milk. This means getting the milk to separate into solid lumps (curds) and a liquid called whey. The photographs below show the steps for producing a hard cheese such as Cheddar.

**CASU MARZU,
A SARDINIAN
CHEESE, IS EATEN
FULL OF LIVE MAGGOTS**

ADDED FLAVOURS

Many people like to eat cheese just as it is. But cheeses are also made with added spices, fruit, and herbs to give them an interesting new taste.

ROSEMARY

CRANBERRIES

PAPRIKA

CHIVES

THYME

GARLIC

ASH

1 CURDLING THE MILK

A machine stirs an enzyme called rennet into the milk to speed curdling.

2 DRAINING AND HEATING

The milk curds are cut into cubes and the whey is allowed to drain off.

3 "CHEDDARING"

The curds are "cheddared" (piled up) to press out more moisture.

4 RIPENING

To shape the cheeses, the curds are put into moulds, then left to ripen.

TOP CHEESE EATERS

The eight countries listed here are where to find the people who eat the most cheese per person per year (in kg/lb).

1 FRANCE

26.3 kg (58 lb) Favourites: Camembert and brie, both soft and creamy cheeses.



2 ICELAND

24.1 kg (53 lb) Favourite: Skyr, soft cheese with a yogurt-like texture.



3 GREECE

23.4kg (52 lb) Favourite: feta, tangy, white, and crumbly.



4 GERMANY

22.9 kg (50 lb) Favourites: Gouda, semi-hard and rich-tasting; and Bruder Basil, a semi-soft smoked cheese.



5 FINLAND

22.5 kg (49 lb) Favourites: Oltermanni, semi-soft and buttery; and Aura, blue and creamy.



6 ITALY

21.8 kg (48 lb) Favourites: Parmesan, nutty and grainy; mozzarella, made with buffalo milk; and Gorgonzola, blue-veined and crumbly.



7 SWITZERLAND

20.8 kg (46 lb) Favourites: Emmental, classic "holey" cheese; and Gruyère, firm and nutty.



8 AUSTRIA

19.9 kg (44 lb) Favourites: Bergkäse and Tilsiter, both with a strong taste and smell.



Cheese

Filling a sandwich, used in a sauce, or just nibbled, cheese is one of the world's favourite foods. It is delicious, nutritious, and made in so many varieties that there is a cheese to suit almost everyone. Most people have eaten only a few different cheeses, but there are thousands to try.

HARD CHEESE

This type of cheese is made from cooked curds pressed firmly into shape and left to age. The method removes as much moisture as possible from the curds and produces a solid cheese that keeps well. Semi-hard cheese has a higher moisture content.



BEAUFORT
France



CANESTRATO DI MOLITERNO
Italy



COMTE
France



CANESTRATO PUGLIESE
Italy



PAVE DU NORD
France



GOUDA
Netherlands



GRUYERE
Switzerland



CHEDDAR
UK



CHESHIRE
UK



EDAM
Netherlands



JARLSBERG
Norway



CANTEL
France



MONTEREY JACK
USA/Mexico

SOFT CHEESE

The curds of soft cheeses are not cooked or pressed, but shaped and left to drain. Some types are eaten soon after making. Others are ripened until a wrinkly rind forms. Depending on the type of cheese, the centre may have a creamy or chalky texture.



RICOTTA AFFUMICATA
Italy



FETA
Greece



SUSSEX SLIPCOTE
UK



HOLY GOAT PANDORA
Australia



OLIVET CENDRE
France



MOZZARELLA
Italy



CHABICHOU DU POITOU
France



KETEM
Israel



BRIE DE MELUN
France



WABASH CANNONBALL
USA



WINNIMERE
USA



SAKURA
Japan